

PICK

1. Passage anchor

> “That is exactly why I ****picked it up**** almost straight away.”

Passage meaning

****pick up**** = take something into your hand, especially from a surface or lower position

****拿起；拾起****

Here, the speaker means they physically picked up the book and started reading it almost immediately.

Practice

1. I ****picked up the book**** and started reading.

我****拿起那本書****開始閱讀。

2. She ****picked up the pen**** from the desk.

她從書桌上****拿起那支筆****。

Core meanings of PICK

2. pick — choose/select

= choose one person or thing from several possibilities

****挑選；選擇****

Examples

1. You can ****pick any book**** you like.

你可以****挑任何一本書****。

2. She ****picked the blue one****.

她****選了藍色那個****。

This is the central everyday verb sense.

3. pick someone/something for something

= choose someone or something for a role, purpose, team, etc.

****挑選.....作為.....****

Examples

1. They ****picked her for the team****.
他們****選她加入隊伍****。
2. We ****picked this restaurant for dinner****.
我們****選了這家餐廳吃晚餐****。

Noun: choice / selection

4. pick — choice

= person or thing chosen, or the act of choosing

****選擇；被選中的人 / 物****

Examples

1. That would be my first ****pick****.
那會是我的****首選****。
2. She was the coach's top ****pick****.
她是教練的****第一選擇****。

5. top pick / first pick

= preferred or highest-ranked choice

****首選；第一選擇****

Examples

1. This book is my ****top pick****.
這本書是我的****首選****。
2. He was the team's ****first pick****.
他是球隊的****第一選擇****。

Pick up — lift / take in hand

6. pick up — lift something

= take something into your hand from a surface or lower position

****拿起；拾起****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. She ****picked up the phone****.

她****拿起電話****。

2. He ****picked up a coin**** from the floor.

他從地上****撿起一枚硬幣****。

Pick up — collect someone/something

7. pick up — collect by vehicle / go get

= go somewhere to collect a person or thing

****接；接載；取回****

Examples

1. I'll ****pick you up**** at seven.

我七點來****接你****。

2. She ****picked up the parcel**** after work.

她下班後去****取包裹****。

Very high-value phrasal verb.

Pick up — buy casually

8. pick up — buy/get something

= obtain or buy something, often casually or conveniently

****買到；順便買；取得****

Examples

1. I ****picked up a new notebook**** on the way home.

我回家途中**順便買了一本新筆記本**。

2. She **picked up a copy** at the airport.
她在機場**買到了一本**。

Pick up — learn informally

9. pick up — learn naturally

= learn a language, skill, habit, or information informally through exposure
自然學會；不知不覺學到

Examples

1. He **picked up some French** while living in Paris.
他住在巴黎期間**自然學會了一些法文**。
2. Children often **pick up accents** quickly.
孩子常常很快就**學會口音**。

Pick up — notice / detect

10. pick up — detect

= notice, receive, or detect a signal, sound, smell, detail, etc.
偵測到；接收到；察覺

Examples

1. The microphone **picked up background noise**.
麥克風**收到 / 錄到背景噪音**。
2. The test **picked up a small change**.
測試**偵測到一個小變化**。

Pick up — improve

11. pick up — improve / become stronger

= improve or increase after being weak, slow, or low

****改善；回升；加快****

Examples

1. Business ****picked up**** in the afternoon.

生意下午****好轉了****。

2. The wind ****picked up****.

風勢****增強了****。

Pick up — resume

12. pick up — continue from a previous point

= resume something from where it stopped

****接著繼續；重新開始****

Examples

1. Let's ****pick up where we left off****.

我們從上次停下來的地方****繼續****。

2. The story ****picks up again**** in the next chapter.

故事在下一章****重新展開****。

Pick up — become more energetic / faster

13. pick up the pace / speed

= increase speed or rate of progress

****加快速度；加快步伐****

Examples

1. We need to ****pick up the pace****.

我們需要****加快進度****。

2. The runner ****picked up speed**** near the finish.

跑手接近終點時****加快了速度****。

Pluck / remove

14. pick — pluck something

= remove flowers, fruit, leaves, etc. from a plant by hand

摘；採

Examples

1. She **picked some flowers**.

她**摘了一些花**。

2. We **picked apples** in the orchard.

我們在果園裡**採蘋果**。

15. pick fruit / flowers

= gather fruit or flowers by hand

採水果；摘花

Examples

1. Workers **picked grapes** all morning.

工人整個早上都在**採葡萄**。

2. Don't **pick the flowers**.

不要**摘花**。

Remove small unwanted things

16. pick something out of/from something

= remove a small item using fingers or a pointed tool

挑出；剔除

Examples

1. She **picked a piece of glass out of** the fabric.

她把布料裡的一小塊玻璃**挑了出來**。

2. He **picked the seeds from** the fruit.

他把果肉裡的籽**挑走**。

Eat small amounts

17. pick at food

= eat only small amounts without much appetite

小口吃；挑挑揀揀地吃

Examples

1. She only **picked at her dinner**.

她晚餐只是**隨便吃了幾口**。

2. He sat there **picking at his food**.

他坐在那裡**有一口沒一口地吃**。

Pick at skin / object

18. pick at something

= repeatedly scratch, pull, or touch a small area

摳；摳弄；反覆撥弄

Examples

1. Stop **picking at the scab**.

不要一直**摳那個痂**。

2. She **picked at the loose thread**.

她一直**撥弄那根鬆掉的線**。

Lock/security

19. pick a lock

= open a lock without the key using tools

撬鎖；開鎖

Examples

1. Someone had tried to **pick the lock**.

有人曾試圖**撬開那把鎖**。

2. He learned how to **pick simple locks**.

他學會了怎樣**開簡單的鎖**。

Established distinct sense.

Musical instrument

20. pick — pluck strings

= play a stringed instrument by plucking individual strings

撥弦；彈撥

Examples

1. He **picked the guitar strings** gently.

他輕輕**撥動吉他弦**。

2. She **picked out a melody** on the guitar.

她用吉他**慢慢彈出一段旋律**。

21. pick — plectrum

As a noun:

= small flat tool used to pluck guitar strings

撥片；pick

Examples

1. He dropped his guitar **pick**.

他把吉他**撥片**掉在地上。

2. I prefer a softer **pick**.

我比較喜歡軟一點的**撥片**。

Criticize / target

22. pick on someone

= repeatedly criticize, tease, bully, or unfairly target someone

欺負；針對；找碴

Examples

1. Stop **picking on** your brother.
不要一直**欺負 / 針對你弟弟**。
2. He felt that the teacher was **picking on him**.
他覺得老師一直在**針對他**。

Very high-value phrasal verb.

Find faults

23. pick holes in something

= criticize something by finding small weaknesses or faults

挑毛病；找漏洞

Examples

1. It's easy to **pick holes in** the plan.
要對這個計畫**挑毛病**很容易。
2. The reviewer **picked holes in** every argument.
評論者對每個論點都**挑出了漏洞**。

Carefully distinguish / extract

24. pick out — identify/select

A. choose from a group

挑出

1. She **picked out a dress**.
她**挑了一條裙子**。

B. identify among others

****辨認出****

2. I could ****pick him out**** in the crowd.

我可以在人群中****認出他****。

25. pick out — hear/see a detail

= distinguish a particular sound, detail, or object from a background

****辨別出；聽出****

Examples

1. I could ****pick out her voice**** in the room.

我能從房間裡****辨認出她的聲音****。

2. The telescope lets us ****pick out faint stars****.

望遠鏡讓我們能****辨認出暗淡的星星****。

Carefully choose

26. pick and choose

= choose only the things you like or want, often selectively

****挑挑揀揀；任意挑選****

Examples

1. You can't just ****pick and choose**** which rules to follow.

你不能只****挑自己想遵守的規則****。

2. She likes to ****pick and choose**** her projects.

她喜歡****挑選自己想做的專案****。

Fight / provoke

27. pick a fight / argument

= deliberately start a fight or argument

****挑起爭鬥 / 爭吵****

Examples

1. He was trying to ****pick a fight****.
他在試圖****挑起衝突****。
2. Don't ****pick an argument**** over something so small.
不要為這麼小的事****挑起爭論****。

Sports drafting / selection

28. draft pick

= player selected by a professional sports team in a draft
****選秀順位；被選中的球員****

Examples

1. He was the first ****draft pick****.
他是選秀的****第一順位****。
2. The team traded a future ****pick****.
球隊交易了一個未來的****選秀權****。

Established sports noun sense.

Pick off

29. pick off

= remove, defeat, or attack individuals one by one
****逐個擊破；逐一除掉****

Examples

1. The team ****picked off**** its opponents one by one.
團隊把對手****逐個擊破****。
2. The marksman ****picked off**** the targets individually.
射手把目標****逐一擊中****。

Pick through / over

30. pick through

= search carefully through a group of things

仔細翻找；挑揀

Examples

1. She **picked through** the box of old photographs.

她仔細**翻找**那箱舊照片。

2. Birds **picked through** the rubbish.

鳥在垃圾中**翻找食物**。

31. pick over

= examine a group carefully and choose the best items

仔細挑選；挑剩

Examples

1. Shoppers **picked over** the fruit.

顧客仔細**挑選水果**。

2. By evening, the best items had already been **picked over**.

到了晚上，最好的東西早已被人**挑走了**。

Noun: tool

32. pick — pointed tool

= pointed hand tool used for breaking hard ground, rock, etc.

鎬；尖嘴鎬

Examples

1. He broke the ground with a **pick**.

他用**鎬**破開地面。

2. The miner carried a **pick**.

礦工帶著一把**尖嘴鎬**。

Distinct concrete noun sense.

Related forms

33. picky

= difficult to please because of being very selective

挑剔的；很難取悅的

Examples

1. He is a **picky eater**.

他吃東西很**挑剔**。

2. She is very **picky about clothes**.

她對衣服很**挑剔**。

34. pickiness

= tendency to be very selective or hard to please

挑剔；過度挑選

Examples

1. His **pickiness** makes restaurants difficult.

他的**挑剔**讓選餐廳變得很麻煩。

2. Some degree of **pickiness** is understandable.

某種程度的**挑剔**可以理解。

35. picker

= person or machine that picks, gathers, or selects

採摘者；挑選者；採摘機

Examples

1. Fruit **pickers** started work early.

水果**採摘工**很早就開始工作。

2. The machine works as an automatic **picker**.
這部機器是一種自動**揀選機**。

High-value expressions

36. take your pick

= choose whichever one you want
任你挑；隨你選

Examples

1. There are several colors—**take your pick**.
有好幾種顏色，**隨你挑**。
2. You can **take your pick** of the seats.
座位你可以**任選**。

37. the pick of something

= the best person or thing from a group
精選；最好的一批

Examples

1. These are the **pick of the bunch**.
這些是這一批裡**最好的**。
2. She had the **pick of several offers**.
她可以從幾個提議中**挑最好的**。

38. pick of the bunch

= best person or thing in a group
一群中最好的；佼佼者

Examples

1. This model is the ****pick of the bunch****.

這個型號是當中****最好的一個****。

2. Of all the restaurants we tried, this was the ****pick of the bunch****.

我們試過的餐廳中，這家是****最出色的****。

39. pick someone's brain

= ask someone for ideas, knowledge, or advice

****向某人請教；借用某人的智慧****

Examples

1. Can I ****pick your brain**** about this problem?

我可以就這個問題****請教你一下嗎****？

2. She ****picked his brain**** for career advice.

她向他****請教職業建議****。

Very common informal idiom.

Key contrasts

40. pick vs choose

****choose****

= general neutral word for deciding among alternatives

****選擇****

****pick****

= often more informal and can suggest selecting one item/person from a group

****挑選****

Compare:

> choose a career

> 選擇職業

> pick a shirt

> 挑一件襯衫

They often overlap.

41. pick vs select

****select****

= more formal and deliberate

****挑選 ; 甄選****

****pick****

= more everyday/informal

Compare:

> select candidates

> 甄選候選人

> pick a seat

> 挑個座位

42. pick up vs take

****pick up****

= lift something from a surface/lower position

****take****

= broader; move or carry something with you

Compare:

> ****pick up**** the book from the table

> 從桌上拿起書

> ****take**** the book home

> 把書帶回家

This is the key passage distinction.

43. pick up vs collect

****collect****

= go and obtain someone/something, or gather items together

****接 / 領取 / 收集****

****pick up****

= more conversational and broad; can mean collect, lift, buy, learn, detect, improve, etc.

44. pick vs pluck

****pluck****

= pull something sharply from where it grows/is attached

****拔 ; 摘****

****pick****

= broader everyday word and can mean choose or gather fruit/flowers.

Meaning map

The central everyday concept of ****pick**** is:

****select or take one thing from among possibilities****

From this develop:

Choice

pick a book

→ ****挑選****

Noun

my first pick

→ ****首選****

Passage

pick up a book

→ ****拿起****

Collection

pick someone up

→ ****接人****

Buying

pick something up

→ **順便買到**

Learning

pick up a language

→ **自然學會**

Detection

microphone picks up sound

→ **接收到**

Improvement

business picks up

→ **好轉**

Gathering

pick fruit

→ **採摘**

Eating

pick at food

→ **隨便吃幾口**

Security

pick a lock

→ **撬鎖**

Criticism

pick on someone

→ **針對 / 欺負**

Selection

pick out

→ **挑出 / 辨認出**

Conflict

pick a fight

→ **挑起爭鬥**

The passage uses the physical phrasal-verb branch:

> **picked it up almost straight away**

> → **幾乎馬上把書拿起來開始讀**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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pick — choose	從多個可能中挑選某人 / 某物；選擇
pick someone/something for	為特定角色或用途挑選某人 / 某物
pick — noun choice	被選中的人 / 物；選擇
top/first pick	最優先、最喜歡的選擇；首選
pick up — lift	從桌面、地面等把某物拿起 / 拾起
pick up — collect	到某處接人或領取某物
pick up — buy/get	順便買到 / 取得某物
pick up — learn	透過接觸而自然學會語言、技能、習慣等
pick up — detect	偵測、接收到訊號、聲音、細節等
pick up — improve	情況、生意、天氣等開始好轉 / 增強
pick up — resume	從中斷處重新繼續
pick up the pace/speed	加快進度 / 速度
pick — fruit/flowers	從植物上摘取水果、花等
pick something out of	用手指 / 工具把小東西挑出、剔除
pick at food	沒胃口地只吃少量；有一口沒一口地吃
pick at skin/thread	反覆摳、撥弄某個小地方
pick a lock	不用原鑰匙而撬 / 開鎖
pick — instrument strings	撥動吉他等弦樂器的弦
pick — noun plectrum	彈吉他等用的撥片
pick on someone	反覆欺負、取笑、批評或針對某人
pick holes in	專門挑出某事的毛病 / 漏洞
pick out — choose	從一群中挑出某個
pick out — identify	從背景 / 群體中辨認出某人 / 某物
pick and choose	很有選擇性地只挑自己想要的；挑挑揀揀
pick a fight/argument	故意挑起衝突 / 爭吵
draft pick	職業體育選秀中的選秀順位 / 被選球員
pick off	逐個擊破、逐一除掉
pick through	在一堆東西中仔細翻找
pick over	仔細挑選，常留下較差的東西
pick — tool	用來挖硬土 / 岩石的尖嘴鎬
picky	過度挑選、難以取悅的；挑剔的

picker	採摘、挑選的人或機器	
take your pick	隨你挑 / 任你選	
pick of the bunch	一群中最好的一個 / 最出色者	
pick someone's brain	向某人請教知識、意見或想法	

Passage recap

> “That is exactly why I **picked it up** almost straight away.”

Here:

****pick up** = **to lift or take the book into your hand****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **拿起**

* **拾起**

* contextually: **一拿到手就開始看**

Natural contextual translation:

****正因如此，我幾乎一拿到手就開始看了。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****pick up****

= ****to take something into your hand from a surface or lower position****

****拿起；拾起****

The key contrasts are:

> ****pick** a book**

> → 選一本書

> ****pick up** a book**

> → 拿起一本書

> ****pick up** a friend**

> → 接朋友

> ****pick up** French**

> → 自然學會法文

> business **picks up**

> → 生意好轉

In the passage, **pick up** is the literal **lift/take-in-hand** sense, with the natural implication that the speaker then began reading almost immediately.